Project Report: Digital Literacy Portfolio

Course Code: CSE0001

Scenario: Student Digital Ambassador

Title Page

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1. Introduction

This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, developed through the lens of a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary objective is to demonstrate proficiency in navigating the digital world, from professional profile creation to safe online communication. Over five modules, this report documents the creation of educational infographics, the establishment of a professional technical presence, coding practice, and research into cybersecurity threats. The ultimate goal is to provide a roadmap for peers to use digital tools responsibly and effectively in an academic and professional capacity.

2. Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I designed a one-page visual resource titled "The Student Digital Ambassador's Guide" using **Canva**. The design was created to be highly scannable and covers three essential pillars: a clear definition of digital literacy, essential tools for VIT students (such as VTOP and GitHub), and safe internet practices like Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

I chose a clean, academic-professional aesthetic to ensure the information felt trustworthy for my batchmates. One thing I found particularly interesting was the concept of "Visual Hierarchy"—realizing how font size and icon placement can drastically change how a reader absorbs information. The most difficult part was condensing complex security advice into just a few actionable bullet points without losing the core message.

3. Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I established my foundational professional presence on three key platforms: **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. I used GitHub to host my digital projects and created a specialised profile README to introduce my technical interests. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details to reflect my current B. Tech journey at VIT Bhopal, while my Kaggle profile was set up to explore the AI and Machine Learning community.

GitHub will serve as my permanent version-control home for the next four years. I plan to use LinkedIn for networking with industry professionals and Kaggle to participate in data science competitions as I progress in my AI & ML specialization. Setting these up early ensures that my digital footprint remains professional and growth-oriented throughout my degree.

4. Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

To build my technical and collaborative skills, I utilised **HackerRank and Google Forms**. I completed the "Python Introduction" challenge on HackerRank to practice core programming logic, which resulted in my first skill badge. Additionally, I built a 5-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms to test my batchmates' knowledge of online safety and professional etiquette.

These tools are academically vital; HackerRank helps me prepare for technical interviews and coding assessments, while Google Workspace tools allow for seamless collaboration on group projects. This task reinforced the idea that as a Student Digital Ambassador, I must not only practice these skills but also build tools that help others learn.

5. Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

This module focused on the nuances of digital communication. I drafted two professional emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship. Both drafts followed strict "Netiquette" rules, including clear subject lines and appropriate salutations.

I researched a scenario where a student used an unprofessional, demanding tone in an email to a faculty member, which led to a breakdown in communication and a denied request. This highlighted the importance of tone and structure. I learned that professional digital communication is about building respect and clarity; a poorly structured email can often be as damaging as a technical error in a project.

6. Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

For the final task, I conducted a case study on **Phishing**. I documented a realistic scenario where a student received a fraudulent email mimicking a university login page to steal VTOP credentials. Researching this topic surprised me because of how sophisticated modern social engineering tactics have become, often bypassing basic scepticism.

As a result, I have personally committed to never clicking a link in an email without first verifying the sender's official domain. I also developed a 'Stay Safe Online' checklist that includes specific tips for UPI safety and provides the **National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930)** for reporting incidents. Digital safety is a continuous habit, not a one-time setup.

Conclusion

This project has significantly enhanced my understanding of what it means to be digitally literate in a professional and academic environment. Beyond just using tools, I have learned the importance of maintaining a professional brand, communicating with integrity, and staying vigilant against online threats. As I move forward in my AI & ML career, these foundational digital skills will be as important as the code I write.

References

- **Canva:** canva.com
- **GitHub:** github.com
- **HackerRank:** hackerrank.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com